

money equal to 12 years' pay. After completing their military service, men were free to return to their homes, but many chose to stay in the countries where they had been posted.

Citizens and noncitizens

All legionaries were Roman citizens—men who had rights that others did not (such as being able to vote in elections). However, not all soldiers were legionaries. Many were noncitizens who came from the 40 or so provinces (territories) of the Roman Empire. Known as auxiliaries, these provincial troops were specialist fighters who served as archers, slingers, and cavalry. These soldiers

played a vital role in defending the borders of the empire and the millions of people who lived within it. At the end of his service, an auxiliary soldier was granted Roman citizenship, which improved his status in society.

The emperor's bodyguards

Augustus, the first Roman emperor, created a special group of soldiers known as

